

the colours are punchy and vibrant without tipping into the unnatural. Reds stay deeply saturated while retaining texture and surface detail. Dynamic range is a highlight as the camera handles high-contrast scenes with confidence, keeping bright skies in check while properly exposing subjects in shadow. The detail and sharpness across architectural shots, landscapes and street scenes are impressive, with clean edge-to-edge rendering and no visible chromatic aberration.

Indoors, noise control is excellent and dark backgrounds stay clean while subjects remain sharp. White balance handling under mixed lighting is reliable, which sounds minor until you click a photo in a bookstore or a museum and the image turns orange or green.

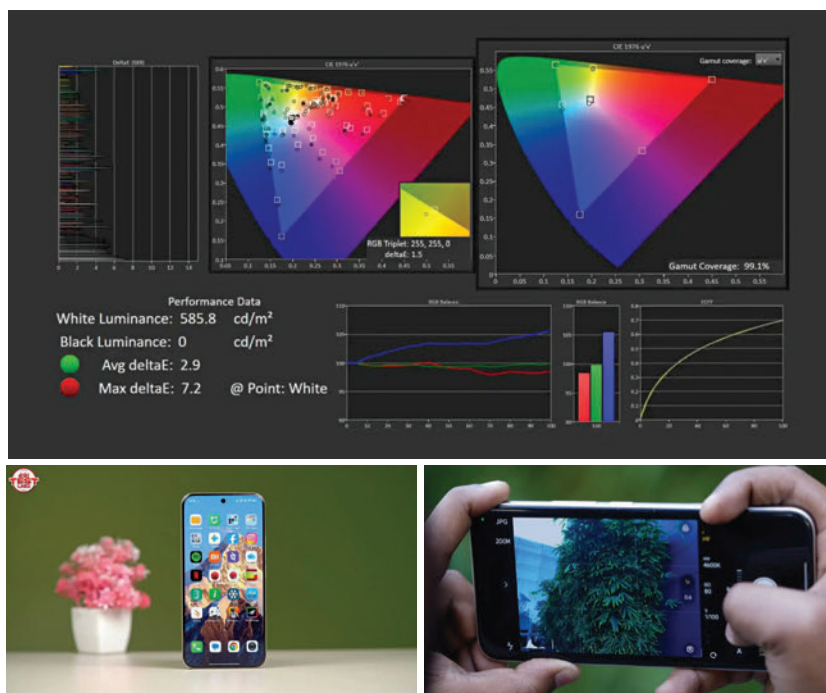
In low light, the highlight roll-off is smooth and bright light sources don't blow out surrounding detail. Fine textures, like floral patterns or intricate metalwork, resolve clearly even in dim conditions. Night mode output is usable and sometimes genuinely impressive.

The zoom situation is better than expected. At 2x, the in-sensor crop produces sharp, detailed images with virtually no degradation. At 4x, there's a slight softening that's visible if you pixel-peep, but the output remains highly usable. It holds up in low light better than you'd expect from a digital crop at this price. That said, it's still not a replacement for a dedicated telephoto lens. If zoom flexibility is important to you, phones like the Realme 16 Pro+ have the hardware advantage.

The portraits benefit from the f/1.7 aperture's natural bokeh. Subject isolation is good, skin tones are accurate and the fall-off from sharp focus to background blur looks gradual rather than computational. The 32MP selfie camera, upgraded from 20MP on the previous generation, handles daylight well.

PERFORMANCE

The Snapdragon 7s Gen 4 is not a flagship chip and it's not trying to be. What it delivers is stable, predictable



performance that doesn't collapse under sustained load. Long gaming sessions, multitasking, video recording, the phone stays composed throughout. Xiaomi's new IceLoop liquid cooling system, replacing the vapour chamber from the Note 14 Pro+, does a credible job of keeping thermals in check. Even when pushed, the phone doesn't aggressively throttle in a way that affects usability.

If raw gaming performance is your absolute priority, other phones at this price will push harder in benchmarks.

The internal hardware LPDDR4X RAM and UFS 2.2 storage are functional and perfectly adequate. But at Rs. 37,999, faster memory and storage would have added headroom for the years of software updates Xiaomi is promising.

HyperOS 2 feels cleaner and more refined than previous versions. AI features like transcription and call noise reduction are present without being intrusive. Xiaomi has committed to four years of Android updates and six years of security patches, up from three and four on the Note 14 Pro+. That's a meaningful improvement and it signals that Xiaomi is serious about the long-term ownership story.

VERDICT

The Redmi Note 15 Pro+ isn't built to dazzle you and Xiaomi has made deliberate trade-offs. Dropping the telephoto lens and sticking with older RAM and storage standards are real compromises. But what this phone does well, it does with consistency and maturity.

At Rs 37,999, the Redmi Note 15 Pro+ wants to earn your trust over time. That's a different kind of value proposition than what Redmi Notes used to offer and for a lot of people, it might be exactly the right one.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 7s Gen 4 | Memory: 8/12 GB LPDDR4X | Storage: 256/512 UFS 2.2 | Display: 6.83-inch 1.5K AMOLED panel | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | Brightness: 2800 nits | Camera (Rear): 200 MP + 8 MP | Camera (Front): 32 MP | Battery: 6,500 mAh | Charging: 100 W wired | IP Rating: IP66, IP68, IP69 and IP69K

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